



Paraguayan harp

First played by traditional folk musicians in rural areas of the country, the harp has become Paraguay's national instrument.



Yacaré caiman

Rivers and swamps are home to this caiman. It was once heavily hunted but is now a protected species.



157,047 sq miles (406,752 sq km)

7.2 million

Asunción

Guaraní, Spanish, German

Forests, hills, grasslands, and swamps are found across Paraguay, which is **landlocked** by **three countries**. The nation's **exports** include crops such as **cotton, coffee, and oilseeds**.

Paraguay



South America

Ñanduti lace

The Spanish brought to Paraguay the traditional, handcrafted lace called Ñanduti, meaning "spiderweb." Today artisans use it to make embroidered clothing in eye-catching colors.



Hardy herders

Since the 18th century, horsemen called gauchos have herded cattle and sheep across the grassy plains of Uruguay.

Mate is traditionally drunk through a metal straw with a filter to keep out leaves.

Herbal brew

The national beverage of southern South America is mate, an herbal drink made from the dried leaves of the yerba mate tree.



Uruguay



The blue and white stripes symbolize the nine original regional departments of Uruguay.

Sea lion colony

One of South America's largest sea lion colonies is found in Cabo Polonio National Park on Uruguay's eastern coast.



The **second-smallest country** on the continent, Uruguay has a **beautiful coastline** and **fertile grasslands**. Half of the population live in the capital city of **Montevideo**.



68,036 sq miles (176,215 sq km)

3.4 million

Montevideo

Spanish